Rebirth: Becoming the Villain in Grimm's Fairy Tales

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INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

In a busy classroom, Emma receives a message. Emma looks at her phone and smile.

ANGLE ON PHONE SCREEN

We see the message "Honey,Happy Birthday! The cake and dinner are ready, and I have a special gift for you."

Emma's fingers hover over the screen, then start typing a reply:"Thank you mom!!! I just got out of class. I'll be home soon.". Then fingers hit sent.

Emma puts her laptop in her backpack and leaves the classroom.

EXT. CAMPUS - DAY

Emma walks while listening to the music. She croons along to the song.

(MUSIC CUE: "APT." by Rosé and Bruno Mars)

A man in black holds a package and watches Emma from a distance, the steps out of the frame.

EXT. EMMA'S HOUSE - DAY

Emma sees the package in front of the door. She picks up the package.

EMMA
Is this a birthday gift for me?

Emma opens the door.

CONTINUOUS

INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Emma's mother is waiting for Emma.

Emma runs over to hug her mother.

EMMA
(showing the package)
Thank you mom!

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EMMA'S MOTHER
(she points her finger at the sofa)
It looks like the present I prepared, but mine's over there.

EMMA
Oh... Who sent me this...

Emma opens the box.

EMMA
Fairy tales? HA,I'm already 21.

Emma's mother is setting the table.

The man in black stands outside the window, looks into the living room, then leave.

EMMA'S MOTHER
This could be from your friend. Anyway, dinner is ready. Honey, make a wish.

Emma walks to the table and her mom lights the candles.

EMMA
I hope I can meet a man who treats me like a prince and have a sweet love

FADE OUT

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Emma walks out from the bathroom after her shower, taking a towel and rubbing her hair. She looks at the storybook putting on her bed and she pauses. Then she walks over, picks up the book and opens it. Emma begins to read.

EMMA
The prince and the princess lived happily ever after.

Emma feels sleepy and falls into a sleep.

FADE TO

EXT. PARK - DAY

Emma opens her eyes and realizes she is in a strange park and wearing a long black dress.

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EMMA
It's so weird... Where am I?

SYSTEM
(voiceover)
Hello Emma, welcome to the Grimn's fairytale world.

EMMA
Who is this talking? what is this place?!

SYSTEM
Congratulations on being selected as a player in this virtual Grimm's Fairy Tales. You will play the role of the villain in stories, and now you have been assigned the story of Snow White.

EMMA
Snow White? The villain? Don't be kidding, who the hell are you? I don't want to be here!

The man in black is in front of the mirror, and the mirror is showing that Emma is talking.

SYSTEM
I am the system of this game, and as long as you complete the tasks, you can immediately back to the reality. I will be your assistant.

EMMA
Is this a virtual reality game, which my good friend sent me this high tech? This is so immersive.

Anyway, that sounds like fun. What specific tasks do I have?

SYSTEM
You are on a mission to become the most beautiful woman in the world, and currently the most beautiful woman in the world is your stepdaughter, Snow White.

EMMA
Oh, yeah, I'm the Evil Queen right now. So if I am to be the most

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beautiful woman, then I should kill Snow White...like the story goes...

SYSTEM
Don't worry, it's just a game. I will provide you with the necessary props and disguises. This is the girdle. As soon as Snow White puts it on, she'll pass out.

A girdle and a bottle of disguise potion appear in Emma's hand.

EMMA
In the story the queen tries to strangle Snow White with a girdle ... Well, let's give it a try.

Emma drinks the disguise potion and gives a surprised look as she sees herself transformed into a middle-aged woman.

EMMA
This is amazing! Okay, I'm ready, where is Snow White now?

SYSTEM
Start transmission

EXT. PARK - DAY

Snow White is sitting on a park bench enjoying the sunshine, wearing sunglasses and holding a burger in her left hand and a bubble tea in her right.

Emma straightens her clothes,then walks over.

EMMA
Oh my god, I've never seen such a lovely girl, your face is absolutely gorgeous. You are truly the most beautiful girl in the world!

SNOW WHITE
Haha. Thank you, but you're very beautiful too, I wouldn't call myself the most beautiful girl.

EMMA
You seem to love these high calorie things. If you get fat, you won't be pretty.

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SNOW WHITE
That's okay, I'd rather enjoy the food.

Emma takes out the girdle.

EMMA
Do you like to have a tiny waist like Kim Kardashian? Try this girdle! So you can have a beautiful body without having to control your diet.

Snow White stands up.

SNOW WHITE
Thanks...I'm happy with my body shape... Bye.

Snow White leaves at a rapid speed.

EXT. DEEP IN THE PARK - DAY

Snow White pulls the camera in front of her, faces the camera.

SNOW WHITE
Another new player, how everyone is exactly the same... Can we do something new?

She is drinking her bubble tea and is about to leave.

SNOW WHITE
A girl don't have to be slim to look good.

CUT TO

EXT. PARK - DAY

Snow White stays where she was.

EMMA
Assistant!

SYSTEM
Yes, Emma.

EMMA
Why this Snow White doesn't follow the original story, huh?

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SYSTEM
Because, fairytale world also evolves with reality. Don't be discouraged, you still have a chance.

A comb and a potion appear in Emma's hand.

SYSTEM
As soon as Snow White uses this comb, she will immediately pass out.

Emma pinches the bottle and drinks all the disguise potion.

EMMA
Okay, I got it, Send me to Snow White.

DISSOLVE TO

EXT. DEEP IN THE PARK - DAY

Emma is turned into a pathetic female figure.

Snow White is enjoying the wind on the bench. Emma looks into Snow White's face from behind a tree with a hesitant expression.

Emma walks over to Snow White in quiet and taps her on the shoulder.

EMMA
Hello beautiful girl, Are you resting here alone?

SNOW WHITE
Oh! You startled me, is there a problem?

EMMA
I'm sorry, I just saw that your hair was a bit messy and I want to brush it for you.

SNOW WHITE
Hmm... Thanks, but it's fine, and I can do it when I get home...

EMMA
What's wrong princess? Is it because I scared you?

Snow White looks straight into the camera.

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ANGLE ON SNOW WHITE'S FACE

SNOW WHITE
(voiceover)
Jeez, her scheming is too obvious. Inexplicable stranger. Does she think I'm stupid?

SNOW WHITE
How did you know I was a princess? I never told you.

Emma freezes.

Snow White turns away.

SYSTEM
Emma, your second attempt failed.

Emma returns to her original appearance.

EMMA
This Snow White is so difficult to deal with.

SYSTEM
The next around is your last chance. If you fail, you will stay in this world forever.

EMMA
What! You didn't tell me this before! I want to quit the game, now!

SYSTEM
This is your last prop.

A basket of apples appears in Emma's hand, and one of them emits a weird fluorescent light.

Emma picks up the apple.

EMMA
..... This apple simply says "I'm poisonous".

SYSTEM
It depends on how you do it.

EMMA
Well, I don't have a choice at this

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point. What about my disguise potion?

SYSTEM
You won't have it this time. Please find your own way...TRANSMITING..

EMMA
What? Wait!...

CUT TO

EXT. HOUSE DOORWAY - NIGHT

Emma feels cold. She knocks on the door.

Emma is shown as the Evil Queen.

SNOW WHITE
Hi stepmother, what brings you here so late?

EMMA
Oh, my dear daughter, how are you? I just came to see you.

SNOW WHITE
Come in, it's cold outside.

CONTINUOUS

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Snow hands Emma a glass of warm water. They sit on the sofa and Snow White looks at Emma with a smile.

Emma looks around.

EMMA
Are you live alone? There is no one else? Emmm...I mean the seven dwarfs or something.

SNOW WHITE
(laughs)
How could there be... I'm a single.

Emma picks up the apple basket.

EMMA
Yeah, yeah, I'm muddled ..... Look, I brought apples for you. I heard that

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eating them is good for your skin and can keep you beautiful.

Emma hands the apple basket to Snow White.

ANGLE ON POISONOUS APPLE

Snow White observes the conspicuous apple with a smile, then picks an ordinary apple from the basket and puts it to her mouth.

SNOW WHITE
Actually, I already knew that you are not really the Queen. My stepmother and father live well together, and if she comes to visit me, father will definitely come with her.

Those strangers were all dressed up by you right?

EMMA
How did you know that?

SNOW WHITE
Because other players I've met before tried to use similar tactics. But you are much gentler than them.

Emma looks down.

EMMA
I'm sorry.

SNOW WHITE
No need to apologize, I know the rules of the game, the previous players told me about it.

EMMA
Did they succeed in going back?

SNOW WHITE
(sighing)
No ..... Even after telling me everything, they still thought the only way to go back was to force me to eat the poisoned apple...

Emma holds her head in her hands and sobs

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EMMA
(whispering)
I don't want to, but I have to be the most beautiful woman in this world to go home.

Snow White looks at Emma. Silent for a moment, Snow White stands up and walks over to Emma, puts hand on her shoulder.

SNOW WHITE
Beauty isn't just on the outside, it's also on the inside. Everyone can be the most beautiful one without comparing themselves to others.

Emma stops sobbing and looks up at Snow White.

SNOW WHITE
Did that guy really want you to hurt me so that you would be the most beautiful after I disappeared?

Emma freezes.

EMMA
Yeah, it wasn't explicitly intended to hurt you, but I read the original story and default to kill...

Emma looks to Snow White. Snow White smiles and nods.

SNOW WHITE
Beauty has many meanings, kindness, courage, compassion, honesty, strength - these are all inner beauty.

Outer appearance will eventually fade with time, only inner beauty will live on. We don't need to be the most beautiful in the eyes of others, just know that we are the most beautiful version of ourselves.

Emma smiles and hugs Snow White.

The lights soften and the room is quiet.

Then Emma closes her eyes and falls into sleep on the sofa.

FADE OUT

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INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Emma sits up from the bed in a cold sweat, gasping for breath. She looks around the room.

Emma looks down and the Grimm's Fairy Tales book is in her hands.

EMMA
Was it all a dream?

She sees the ending of the story.

ANGLE ON THE BOOK

We see the contents on the page:"With her kindness, Snow White taught many girls to be brave and confident, and how to solve difficulties in life. She lived in harmony with her stepmother, and she was independent and happy."

Emma gazes at the end of the story and she smiles.

She closes the book.

EMMA
Princesses aren't fragile, they have strength and intelligence. Exactly like the female in reality, we are independent and freedom.

Emma lets out a long breath.

FADE IN

EXT. OUTSIDE EMMA'S ROOM - NIGHT

The Man in Black stands outside the door, staring into the room.

Emma's mother stands beside the Man in Black, looking up at him. They look at each other for a few moments and smile.

The Man in Black then leaves. The mother glances at Emma's room and leaves with a smile as well.

FADE OUT

THE END

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